

Dear Carrot hiring team,

Reliability, automation, mentoring, and "cleaning up messes" are the bulk of my job right now. I started at Pharmacists Mutual as an intern in 2016 and I'm still here, ten years on - but now I work as the Lead Data Engineer for our data extracts and integrations.

The part I'm proudest of is a mess I inherited. Our third-party reporting vendor failed, so I took over the enterprise ETL, the SQL architecture, and the reporting stack, rebuilding it from the ground up - better, faster, stronger. (It wasn't quite 6 million dollars). SSIS, SQL Server, Tabular models, Power BI, and a new Ataccama Master-Data-Management layer were all part of the new design, all documented this time. Post-implementation, our storage dropped 50% and processing time fell by over 60%. I was the sole technical decision-maker on all of it, reporting straight to company leadership. The Ataccama MDM/Data-Quality piece was a completely new tech for me - and thus my favorite part.

Since March 2026 I've led the team. I set the direction for our move from on-prem SQL Server to a medallion lakehouse on Azure and Microsoft Fabric, hired a senior engineer, currently run the onboarding, and serve as mentor for the other team members. I trained the team on our Ataccama setup and the SSIS pipelines. I also pushed Claude Code adoption into both the software and data teams, leading that training on the tool for the rest of our engineering department. (One of my older coworkers had never seen agentic coding before: he lost his mind when he saw it could write integration tests for him). That agentic integration cut our story delivery time roughly in half.

On my own time I built Gutenberg-Fingerprint, a nightly change-data-capture pipeline that I run solo on a ~\$5/month VPS. Postgres, Python, dbt Core, and Dagster, with source freshness checks, audit logging, a full dbt test suite, and OpenTofu for provisioning. I haven't used Snowflake, Prefect, or Airflow in prod. Orchestration, dbt, and warehouse/lakehouse architecture are bread and butter for me, so I'd ramp fast.

I do the hands-on work and the team work. I like both, but if I had to choose one, I'm a builder at heart. I love being hands-on in the code, and seeing a thing reach completion. If it sounds to you like I might be a good fit for this role, feel free to reach out through any form I gave in the post/resume. (And if not, no hard feelings).

All the best,
Sander VanWilligen